

► **PVR INOX, THE** newly merged multiplex giant, is enhancing its combined ₹1,500-crore F&B business as part of its target to achieve ₹225 crore in cost and revenue synergies over the next 12-18 months.

F&B typically contributes 30 per cent to a multiplex's revenues. It is the biggest driver of profits as revenue from ticket sales must be shared with producers and distributors, which is not the case with F&B sales. A moviegoer at PVR spent an average ₹120 on F&B. The metric, known as spend per head (SPH), stood at ₹100 for INOX. PVR INOX Executive Director Sanjeev Bijli estimates the combined entity's SPH to be closer to ₹120 and says the aim is to boost F&B's contribution to overall revenue to 35 per cent.

"It goes down to facility planning, kitchen planning and menu planning. Most of INOX's circuit

F&B IS THE BIGGEST DRIVER OF PROFITS FOR MULTIPLEXES, AND NEED NOT BE SHARED WITH OTHERS

has been vegetarian but we have identified 50 sites where conversion to a non-vegetarian menu will automatically yield good results and add to our F&B sales," adds Bijli, citing locations such as Punjab, Delhi, Kerala and Karnataka's Bengaluru. Leveraging technology to upsell F&B products on their own apps and tying up with delivery people are also important parts of the plan.

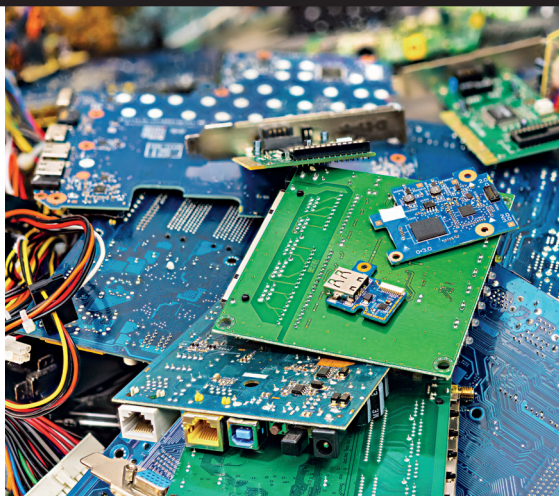
The two erstwhile rivals officially merged on February 6, 2023, and

began integrating the companies from March. PVR INOX is now the country's largest cinema multiplex chain with almost 1,680 of India's estimated 9,000 screens.

Gautam Dutta, who was PVR CEO, and Alok Tandon, who was INOX Leisure CEO, have been made co-CEOs of the merged entity. Operationally, the former will look after North and South, and the latter West, East, and Central. The entity plans to open 150 new screens in FY24 with a capex of ₹500 crore.

Bijli says ramping up distribution of Hindi, regional and English language films through their PVR Pictures is another focus area. Finer details of achieving other cost and revenue efficiencies for the ₹225-crore synergy target are being worked out, he says. **BT**

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| THE RECYCLING PUSH |

Making Sense of Waste

The new e-waste recycling rules could solve India's burgeoning e-waste problem

BY NIDHI SINGAL

► **AS INDIA'S** e-waste problem grows, with 1.1 million tonnes of e-waste generated in 2019-20—just after China and the US, the government has taken specific measures towards formalising the e-waste recycling space in the country. Replacing the E-Waste (Management) Rules, 2016—that made it compulsory for dismantling and recycling units to get authorisation from the concerned departments—are the E-Waste (Management) Rules, 2022, that kicked in from April 1, 2023.

The latest rules introduce the new Extended Producer Responsibility (EPR) regime that will apply to every manufacturer, producer, refurbisher, dismantler and re-

cycler of electronic products, with the scope of products also being expanded. "The coverage has increased from 30 to more than 100 products and virtually everything that runs on electricity has now been covered," says Nitin Gupta, Co-founder & CEO of Attero Recycling.

Now, along with getting registered, producers would be assigned annual recycling targets in the range of 60-80 per cent of the goods produced or sold by them. Not only that, they would also be required to raise awareness about e-waste through various channels. **BT**

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